SkillNavora

MODULE 22 HANDBOOK

Module 22: SFMC Testing, Troubleshooting and Performance

4 sections, 33 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 22: SFMC Testing, Troubleshooting and Performance

Level: Advanced. Testing campaigns and integrations, troubleshooting failures and tuning performance.

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Detailed lessons

Module 22

22.1 Testing and troubleshooting

WHAT IS IT?

> Test email previews, personalisation, links, journeys with test contacts, automations on sample data, SQL on small populations and APIs with sandbox calls. Troubleshooting follows the error, the logs and recent changes.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Most production incidents are preventable with a test plan.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Send tests to seed addresses.
2. Check each personalisation with a missing value.
3. Run SQL on a sample before a full run.
4. Keep a runbook.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A seed-list test shows a broken personalisation before the real send.

COMMON ERRORS

Testing only with one perfect record.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

How would you investigate a failed email send?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Create a test plan for a welcome email and journey.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Trailhead (free learning)

22.1 SFMC Testing: every topic explained

Email testing. Preview, test sends and link checks.

Personalisation testing. Checking personalisation with varied data.

Journey testing. Testing journeys with test contacts.

Automation testing. Running automations on test data.

SQL query testing. Testing queries on small data.

API testing. Testing API calls in a sandbox.

CloudPages testing. Testing forms and pages.

Mobile messaging testing. Testing SMS and push.

22.2 Troubleshooting: every topic explained

Email send failures. Check the send log, audience, classification and content errors.

Subscriber errors. Check status, keys and data.

Data extension errors. Check field types, keys and nullable fields.

SQL errors. Check syntax, field names and supported functions.

Journey entry problems. Check the entry source, filters, re-entry and activation.

Automation failures. Check run history and the failed activity.

API errors. Check status codes, tokens and request bodies.

AMPscript errors. Check variable names, lookups and missing data.

CloudPages errors. Check page code, parameters and data writes.

Deliverability issues. Check authentication, bounces and complaints.

22.3 Performance Optimisation: every topic explained

SQL query optimisation. Select needed fields, filter early and avoid unnecessary joins.

Data extension optimisation. Index-friendly keys and lean tables.

Automation scheduling. Avoid peak times and long chains.

Journey performance. Keep journeys simple and avoid unnecessary splits.

Asset organisation. Clean folders and naming.

API efficiency. Batch calls and respect limits.

Data volume management. Archive old data and set retention.

22.4 Production Support: every topic explained

Incident management. Detect, triage, fix and communicate incidents.

Root-cause analysis. Find the underlying cause.

Error logs. Reading error logs and run history.

Monitoring. Watching dashboards and alerts.

Escalation. Bringing in the right people.

Change management. Controlled changes with approval.

Release validation. Checks after each release.

Post-incident reporting. A short report on what happened and what will change.